RUNNING THE STORE · 6 MIN READ

The CRM: every inquiry, every follow-up

The CRM is where every bike inquiry lives, from the first call to the sale or the loss. If an inquiry is not in the CRM, the store cannot follow it up and nobody can see it was ever there.

What goes into an inquiry

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Source	How they reached us: Call, Walk-in or WhatsApp.
Name and phone	Always the phone number. Without it there is no follow-up.
Category	Road, Hybrid, MTB, Kids, E-bike, Accessories, Service, Wearables or Other.
Budget	The figure the customer gave, not your guess.
Rider height and inseam	In centimetres. This decides frame size, so ask early.
Next follow-up	The date you will contact them again.

Status: open, bought or lost

- **Open**: still in play. An open inquiry must always have a next follow-up date.
- **Bought**: the sale is done.
- **Lost**: closed without a sale. You must pick a reason: Price, Bought elsewhere, Bought at other store, No stock / size, Just browsing, Not responding, or Other.

Pick the true reason. "Not responding" is the easy choice, and it hides what really happened. If the customer said the price was too high, the reason is Price.

Notes: one for every contact

Each time you speak to the customer, add a note and mark the channel: Call, WhatsApp, Visit, or Note for anything else. Write what was said and what happens next. A good note lets anyone in the store pick up the conversation tomorrow.

Waiting list

If the customer wants a model or size we do not have, record the model and size on the inquiry and mark it as waiting. When stock arrives, these are the first people to call. Do not mark them lost.

The same customer at two stores

The CRM warns you when a phone number already has an inquiry at another store. Both stores keep working the lead, both inquiries are flagged, and the credit goes to whoever closes the sale. Do not stop following up because another store is involved, and do not hide the inquiry.

After the sale

Mark the inquiry Bought, then ask for a Google review and record that you asked.

Four habits

- Enter the inquiry the same day, while you remember the details.
- Add a note after every contact.
- Never leave an open inquiry without a follow-up date.
- Close as lost only with the real reason.

Remember these

- Every inquiry goes in the same day, with a phone number.
- Open means there is a next follow-up date. Always.
- One note per contact, with the channel and the next step.
- Out of stock is a waiting entry, not a lost inquiry.